

Hands-on Workshop on Research Work

Selecting research issue and framing research title

Bijay Lal Pradhan

Tribhuvan University

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Presentation Outline

Training Objectives

Research Productivity Tools and Digital Skills

From Research Idea to Research Proposal

From Research Gap to Final Research Title

Training Objectives

Training Objectives

The objective of this course is to develop knowledge and skills on:

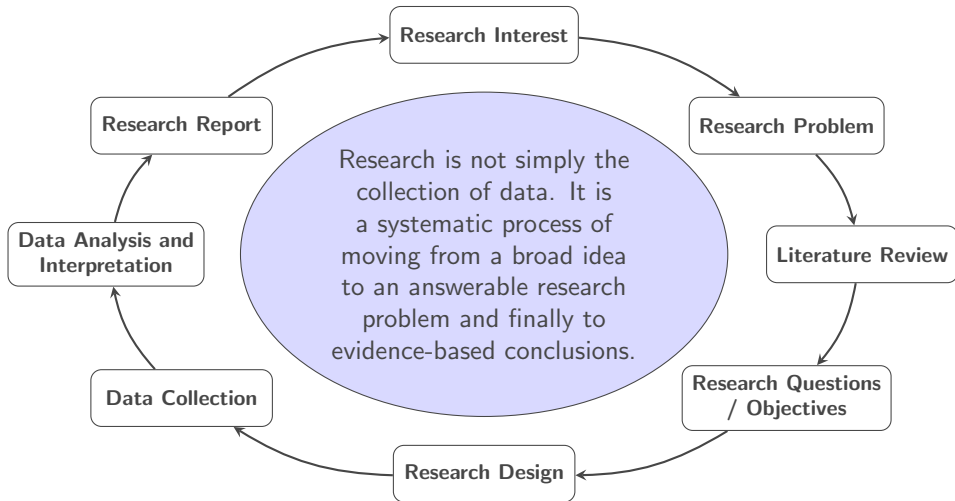
- ▶ Designing and writing an academic research proposal.
- ▶ Selecting appropriate research methods and designs.
- ▶ Collecting and analyzing research data.
- ▶ Conducting academic research systematically.
- ▶ Writing and presenting a scientific research report.

Major Components of Research

1. Develop Research Idea
2. Writing of Research Proposal
3. Conducting Academic Research
4. Analysis and Interpretation of Data
5. Scientific Report Writing

Research Idea → Proposal → Research → Report

The Complete Research Journey



Research Productivity Tools and Digital Skills

Research Productivity Tools and Digital Skills

1. Academic Literature Search

[Google Scholar](#), [Semantic Scholar](#), academic databases, Boolean search, and citation searching.

2. Reference Management

[Zotero](#)/ [Mendeley](#), citation management, bibliography generation, and reference organization. [Endnote](#) is another one can be download from [mywebsite](#).

3. Digital Literature Review

Literature matrix, [ResearchRabbit](#), [Connected Papers](#), and research gap identification.

4. Digital Research Writing

[Microsoft Word](#), [Overleaf](#)/LaTeX, collaborative writing, formatting, and document management.

Research Productivity Tools and Digital Skills (Continued)

5. Digital Data Collection

[Google Forms](#), [KoboToolbox](#), survey design, data validation, and digital data management.

6. Data Analysis Software

[Excel](#)/ [SPSS](#)/ [R](#) for quantitative analysis and [Tagutte](#)/ [NVivo](#)/ [ATLAS.ti](#)/ [MAXQDA](#) for qualitative analysis. There are many freeware software like [JASP](#), [Jamovi](#), [gretl](#) etc.

7. AI-Assisted Research

[Elicit](#) [Review Matrix, Metadata], [Consensus](#) [Review writing], [NotebookLM](#), [SciSpace](#),. Literature discovery, evidence synthesis, research paper analysis, citation verification, document-based research.

8. Research Project Management

[Notion Trello](#) [Task Management]; [Google Drive](#) [Cloud Storage, File Organization, Collaboration].

From a Broad Topic to a Research Problem

Broad Area

Digital Public Service Delivery



Specific Topic

Digital Public Service Delivery in Local Governments



Research Problem

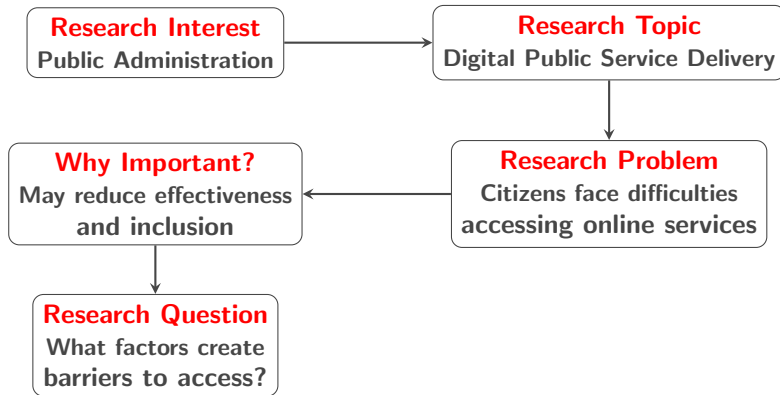
Despite the expansion of digital public services, citizens may still face barriers related to access, digital literacy, infrastructure, and institutional capacity.



Research Question

What factors affect the effective delivery and utilization of digital public services?

From Research Interest to Research Problem: Example



From Research Idea to Research Proposal

From Knowing Research Tools to Doing Research

Research Productivity Tools



Finding a Research Interest



Identifying a Real-World Problem



Developing a Research Topic



Finding Research Evidence

Activity I: Identify Your Research Interest

Ask yourself:

1. What subject or issue interests you the most?
2. Which area of Public Administration would you like to study?
3. Do you prefer studying **people, organizations, policies, institutions, or data**?
4. What problems have you observed in government or public service delivery?
5. Is there any issue that you would like to understand, explain, or improve?

Your Task

Write down **one broad area of research interest**.

Possible Research Interest Areas in Public Administration

- ▶ Public Policy
- ▶ Local Governance
- ▶ Public Service Delivery
- ▶ E-Governance
- ▶ Public Financial Management
- ▶ Public Sector Human Resource Management
- ▶ Development Administration
- ▶ Good Governance
- ▶ Citizen Participation
- ▶ Administrative Reform
- ▶ Public Accountability
- ▶ Digital Government
- ▶ Disaster Governance
- ▶ Gender and Social Inclusion

Remember

Your research interest is only the **starting point**. It is not yet a research problem.

From Interest to Research Topic

Interest Area

What I am interested in studying

+

Real-World Problem

What is happening or what needs to be understood or improved?

⇓

Research Topic

What my research will investigate, explain, or understand

Example: From Interest to Research Topic

Interest Area

Digital Public Service Delivery



Observed Problem

Citizens face difficulties accessing and using online public services.



Possible Research Topic

Barriers to Accessing Digital Public Services among Citizens

Possible Research Question

What factors create barriers to accessing digital public services?

Activity II: Identify a Real-World Problem

Think about your experience, workplace, community, or public institution.

Ask yourself:

- ▶ What problem have I observed?
- ▶ Who is affected by this problem?
- ▶ Why might this problem exist?
- ▶ Why is this problem important?
- ▶ Can this problem be investigated through research?

Your Task

Write **real-world problem** related to your interest area.

From Interest and Problem to Research Topic

Interest Area	Observed Problem	Possible Research Topic
Digital Government	Citizens face difficulties accessing online services	Barriers to Accessing Digital Public Services
Local Governance	Limited citizen participation in local decision-making	Factors Affecting Citizen Participation in Local Governance
Public Service Delivery	Long waiting times and inefficient services	Factors Affecting Efficiency in Public Service Delivery
Public Accountability	Limited transparency in public institutions	Public Accountability and Transparency in Local Government

From Interest and Problem to Research Topic

Interest Area	Observed Problem	Possible Research Topic
Human Resource Management	Employees experience low motivation and job satisfaction	Factors Affecting Employee Motivation and Job Satisfaction
Leadership	Employees report limited support from organizational leaders	Leadership Style and Employee Performance
Marketing Management	Businesses struggle to convert social media engagement into purchases	Social Media Marketing and Consumer Purchase Intention
Financial Management	Small businesses face difficulties in managing financial resources	Financial Management Practices and Business Performance
Entrepreneurship	New businesses face difficulties in sustaining their operations	Factors Affecting Entrepreneurial Success among Small Businesses
Corporate Governance	Weak governance practices affect organizational performance	Corporate Governance and Organizational Performance

From Interest and Problem to Research Topic

Interest Area	Observed Problem	Possible Research Topic
Legal Awareness	Citizens have limited knowledge of their legal rights and obligations	Legal Awareness and Access to Justice among Citizens
Consumer Protection	Consumers face difficulties obtaining effective remedies for unfair practices	Consumer Awareness and Effectiveness of Legal Protection
Labour Law	Workers have limited awareness of their statutory rights	Awareness of Labour Rights among Private-Sector Employees
Cyber Law	Internet users face privacy and cyber-related concerns	Cyber Law Awareness and Online Privacy Practices among Internet Users
Access to Justice	Some citizens face barriers to obtaining affordable legal services	Factors Affecting Access to Justice

From Research Topic to Keywords

Example Research Topic

Barriers to Accessing Digital Public Services among Citizens

1. **Core Concepts**

Digital public services; access barriers

2. **Context**

Citizens; local government; Nepal

3. **Synonyms**

E-government; digital government; online public services

Possible Keywords

Digital government; e-government; online public services; access barriers; digital inclusion; citizens

From Research Topic to Keywords

Example Research Topic

Social Media Marketing and Consumer Purchase Intention

1. **Core Concepts**

Social media marketing; consumer purchase intention

2. **Context**

Consumers; online shopping; Nepal

3. **Synonyms**

Social media advertising; digital marketing; buying intention

Possible Keywords

Social media marketing; digital marketing; social media advertising; consumer purchase intention; buying intention; online consumers

From Research Topic to Keywords

Example Research Topic

Legal Awareness and Access to Justice among Citizens

1. Core Concepts

Legal awareness; access to justice

2. Context

Citizens; legal services; Nepal

3. Synonyms

Legal literacy; access to legal remedies; justice accessibility

Possible Keywords

Legal awareness; legal literacy; access to justice; legal services; legal remedies; citizens

Searching for Research Literature

Example Search String

"digital public services" AND "access barriers"

Alternative Search

("e-government" OR "digital government") AND ("digital inclusion" OR "service access") AND Nepal

- ▶ **AND** — includes both concepts
- ▶ **OR** — includes alternative terms
- ▶ **" "** — searches an exact phrase
- ▶ ***** — searches word variations

Practical Activity: Literature Search

Search your research topic using Google Scholar.

For each article, check:

1. Title
2. Author and year
3. Abstract
4. Research context
5. Methodology
6. Key findings
7. Citation count
8. Relevance to your research topic

Important

Do not simply collect papers. Read the abstract and evaluate whether the article is relevant to your research.

Organizing the Literature: Review Matrix

Author & Year	Study Focus	Method	Key Findings	Research Gap
Study 1				
Study 2				
Study 3				
Study 4				

Purpose

The review matrix helps you organize research evidence, compare studies, and identify possible research gaps.

Organizing the Literature: Review Matrix

Title	Year	Method	Sample	Key Finding	Theme	Contribution	Limitation
Study 1	2024	Quantitative Survey	250 employees	Leadership significantly influences employee performance	Leadership	Identifies leadership factors associated with employee performance	Cross-sectional design; self-reported data
Study 2	2023	SEM	300 consumers	Social media marketing positively affects purchase intention	Digital Marketing	Provides empirical evidence on social media and consumer behavior	Limited to selected consumers
Study 3	2022	Mixed Methods	180 SMEs	Financial management practices are associated with business performance	Financial Management	Links financial practices with SME performance	Small and geographically limited sample
Study 4	2021	Survey	400 citizens	Legal awareness is associated with access to justice	Legal Awareness	Highlights the role of legal knowledge in accessing justice	Limited institutional and contextual coverage

Download

You can download excel tempelete for Review Matrix from [► Download Literature Review Matrix Tempelete](#)

From Literature Review to Research Gap

What do previous studies already tell us?
What is missing, limited, unclear, or unexplored?

Research Gap

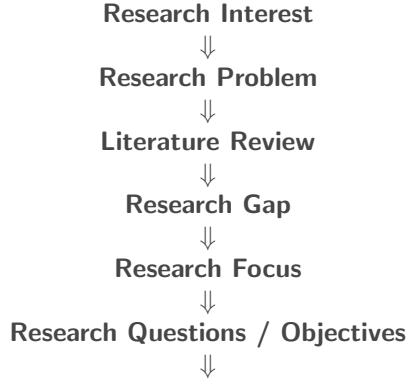
The specific area where additional research is needed.

Examples:

- ▶ Limited evidence in a particular context
- ▶ Limited geographical or population coverage
- ▶ Methodological limitations
- ▶ Inconsistent research findings
- ▶ Important variables have been ignored

From Research Gap to Final Research Title

What Comes After Identifying a Research Gap?



Final Research Title

A clear, specific, feasible, and researchable title

What Makes a Good Research Title?

A good research title should communicate the study clearly without unnecessary words.

1. **Clear** – the meaning should be immediately understandable.
2. **Specific** – avoid overly broad topics.
3. **Researchable** – the topic should be investigated using appropriate evidence and methods.
4. **Focused** – identify the major concepts, population, institution, or context.
5. **Feasible** – data, time, resources, and access should be realistic.
6. **Relevant** – the topic should address a meaningful academic or practical issue.

Key Principle

A research title should tell the reader **what is being studied, among whom, and in what context.**

A Simple Formula for Developing a Research Title

Basic Structure

Main Concept / Variables + Population / Unit + Context



Example

Factors Affecting Citizen Satisfaction with Digital Public Services in Local Governments of Nepal

Decomposing a Research Title

Example Title

Factors Affecting Citizen Satisfaction with Digital Public Services in Local Governments of Nepal

Component	Example
Research focus	Citizen satisfaction
Possible explanatory factors	Service quality, accessibility, digital literacy, trust
Population	Citizens
Context	Digital public services
Geographical / institutional context	Local governments of Nepal

Question

Can you identify the same components in your own proposed title?

From a Broad Title to a Specific Title

Too Broad

Digital Government in Nepal



More Specific

Digital Public Service Delivery in Local Governments



More Focused

Citizen Access to Digital Public Services in Local Governments



Researchable Title

Factors Affecting Citizen Access to Digital Public Services in Local Governments of Nepal

Avoid Overly Broad Research Titles

Too Broad

Governance in Nepal

Public Administration

Education in Nepal

Digital Transformation

Social Media

More Focused

Citizen Participation in Local Governance

Administrative Factors Affecting Public Service Delivery

Factors Affecting Student Satisfaction in Public Universities

Digital Transformation and Service Delivery in Local Governments

Social Media Marketing and Consumer Purchase Intention

Remember

A broad area may be suitable for discussion, but a research study requires a **manageable focus**.

Identifying Variables from a Research Title

Example

Leadership Style and Employee Performance

Element	Example
Independent Variable	Leadership Style
Dependent Variable	Employee Performance
Population	Employees
Possible Context	Organizations / institutions

Activity

Underline the possible independent and dependent variables in your proposed research title.

Common Structures of Research Titles

1. **Factors Affecting...**

Factors Affecting Employee Performance in Public Organizations

2. **Relationship between...**

Relationship between Financial Literacy and Investment Decisions

3. **Impact / Effect of...**

Effect of Social Media Marketing on Consumer Purchase Intention

4. **Role of...**

Role of Citizen Participation in Local Governance

5. **Assessment of...**

Assessment of Public Service Delivery in Local Governments

6. **Perceptions / Experiences of...**

Citizens' Perceptions of Digital Public Service Delivery

Choose the Title Structure According to Your Study

If your study asks...

What factors explain an outcome?

Are two concepts related?

Does X influence Y?

What role does something play?

What is the current situation?

How do people experience something?

Possible title structure

Factors Affecting...

Relationship between...

Effect / Impact of X on Y

Role of...

Assessment / Status of...

Perceptions / Experiences of...

Important

Title should be consistent with the **research question and design**.

Research Title ↔ Research Question

Research Title

Factors Affecting Citizen Access to Digital Public Services in Local Governments of Nepal

Research Question

What factors affect citizens' access to digital public services in local governments of Nepal?

Alignment

The research title and research question should communicate the **same central research focus**.

Research Title ↔ Research Objectives

Research Title

Factors Affecting Citizen Access to Digital Public Services in Local Governments of Nepal

Possible Objectives

1. To assess the level of citizen access to digital public services.
2. To identify the major barriers affecting access to digital public services.
3. To examine the relationship between digital literacy and access to digital public services.
4. To assess the role of service accessibility and institutional support in digital service utilization.

Alignment Check

Title → Research Questions → Objectives should form a logical chain.

Is Your Research Title Feasible?

Before finalizing the title, ask:

1. **Data** :Can I obtain the required data?
2. **Population** :Can I reach the target population?
3. **Time** :Can the study be completed within the available time?
4. **Resources** :Do I have sufficient financial, technical, and human resources?
5. **Skills** :Do I have the skills required for the proposed analysis?
6. **Ethics and Access** :Can I obtain the necessary permission and informed consent?

Keep in Mind

A theoretically interesting topic is not necessarily a **feasible research topic**.

Research Title: Quality Checklist

Before accepting your title, check each item:

- ☐ Is the research problem clearly reflected?
- ☐ Is the main concept or phenomenon clear?
- ☐ Is the target population identified?
- ☐ Is the context or study setting clear?
- ☐ Is the geographical scope appropriate?
- ☐ Can the topic be investigated empirically?
- ☐ Is the title neither too broad nor too narrow?
- ☐ Can the required data realistically be collected?
- ☐ Does the title match the research questions?
- ☐ Does the title match the proposed objectives?

Activity III: Refine Your Research Title

Step 1: Write your first title

Step 2: Identify

- ▶ Main concept / phenomenon
- ▶ Target population
- ▶ Context
- ▶ Location
- ▶ Possible variables

Step 3: Remove

- ▶ Unnecessary words
- ▶ Overly broad concepts
- ▶ Ambiguous terms

Step 4: Rewrite your title

Activity IV: Peer Review Your Research Title

Exchange your proposed title with a colleague.

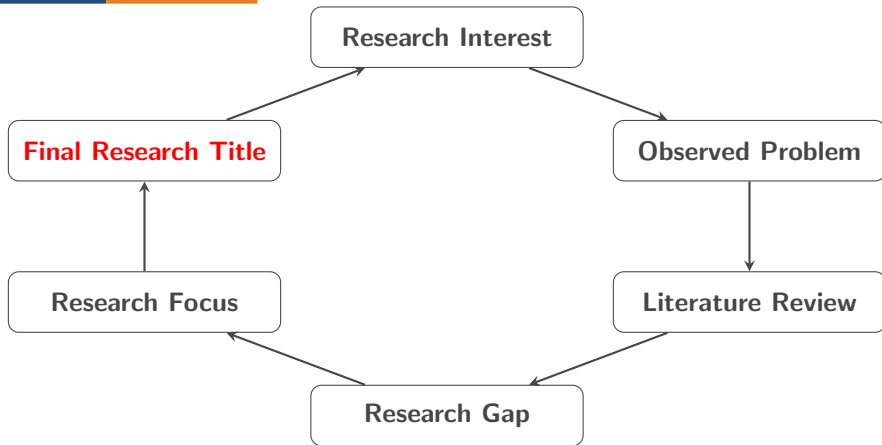
Ask your colleague to answer:

1. What do you think this research is about?
2. Who or what is being studied?
3. What appears to be the main research problem?
4. Is the title sufficiently specific?
5. Is the title feasible within the available time and resources?
6. What part of the title could be clarified?

Useful Note

If another researcher cannot understand the intended study from the title, the title needs further refinement.

From Research Problem to Final Research Title



Key Message

A research title is not selected in isolation. It is developed from a **problem, evidence, gap, and research focus**.

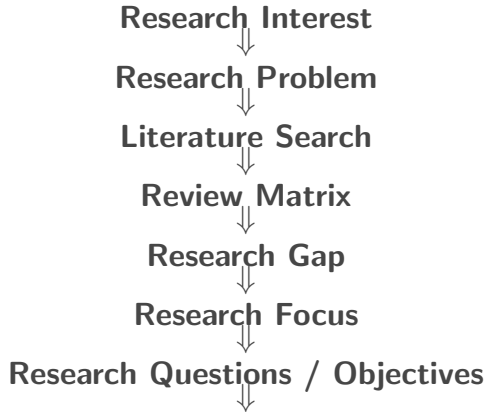
Final Workshop Task: Develop Your Research Title

Complete the following sequence:

1. Write your **broad research interest**.
2. Identify a **real-world problem**.
3. Search and review relevant literature.
4. Prepare your **literature review matrix**.
5. Identify a specific **research gap**.
6. Define your **research focus**.
7. Identify the key concepts or variables.
8. Define the target population and context.
9. Draft your **research title**.
10. Check the title for clarity, specificity, relevance, and feasibility.

Output of the Activity: One refined research title

What Have We Done?



Research Title

Clear + Focused + Researchable + Feasible

Thank You

Questions and Discussion

From curiosity to evidence, research is a journey of systematic inquiry.